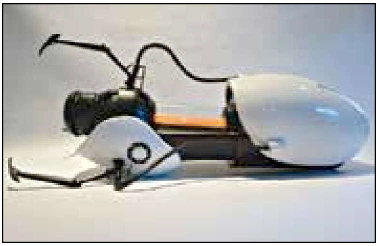

Whether you print a game gun or a real gun, with the internet the freedom is in your hands.

experimentation. Using these items people are able to create objects used in day to day life such as combs, key copies, phone covers, cutlery and anything you can imagine. At the current stage of product development and cost effectiveness, the restraints are limited to materials used (mainly plastics) and the size of the object.

The Maker movement is mainly interested in the possibilities of 3D printing and seeks to normalise its presence in the consumer world. As the coming decade comes to an end, patents on advanced 3D printing methods will expire and a wave of multi-material, large scale home printing options will become accessible to the public. The Maker movement's key priority is to encourage self-reliance with respect to personal goods and the learning of the necessary tools to make it happen; from traditional methods to 3D printing. But only with the latter have they seen a remarkable interest and growth in the proliferation of DIY manufacturing.

Educational use

Outside of the fragmented personal and individual user demographic of 3D printers lies the larger not-for-profit institutions such as schools, universities, research labs and government agencies. The real level of innovation that is exciting and relatable takes place at these places where imagination meets resources, and the willingness to experiment. In fact, schools and universities are not only one of the earliest adopters of the technology but critical contributors in the development of the technology itself.

Using the novelty appeal of a 3D printing demonstrations teachers are able to cultivate hands-on learning and explore areas of conceptualisation, design, technology application, applied sciences and small scale manufacturing. For students in the field of architecture, multimedia, arts and engineers, the use of 3D printers greatly enhances the learning experience as students are able to create functional scale models of their ideas quickly and accurately.